

Gate A review - Retail Orders

1. Unlock condition

This review is answer material. It may be opened only after the genuine Gate workbook and evidence have been saved. Do not use it while building the first attempt.

2. How to compare

Compare in this order: source/result grain -> quality/rejection rules -> lookup/master-key/not-found handling -> formulas/conditional aggregates -> Pivot/report -> Power Query refresh evidence -> relationship/cardinality -> reconciliations -> findings/limitations. A matching final number does not prove a sound workbook.

3. Critical pass rule

No percentage-average shortcut. Any critical failure can block the Gate: corrupt raw data, wrong grain, hidden invalid/not-found rows, unproven duplicate master key, formula logic that changes business meaning, unreconciled important totals, manual fixes substituted for refreshable preparation, indefensible cardinality, report contradictions, or inability to explain the analysis.

4. Fresh assessment integrity

Gate A uses the distinct Retail Orders scenario. Its purpose is transfer, not memory. Do not copy layouts/formulas from a previous Gate when a fresh build is required.

Protected validation controls

Control	Expected value
Input Rows	42
Valid Rows	39
Rejected Rows	3
Unknown Product Rows	2
Matched Rows	37
Net Sales Total	905,192.00
Late Non Cancelled Rows	11
Top Region	East
Top Region Sales	285,275.00

5. How to use these controls

If your value differs, do not type the expected value into the workbook. Trace the calculation: raw -> rejection/quality logic -> prepared rows -> enrichment -> metric -> Pivot/report. Repair the earliest incorrect step, then rerun downstream validations.

Diagnostic rubric and exact next route

Source & grain	Raw preserved; one-row grain and output grain are explicit.
Quality & rejection	Required blanks/invalids/unknown keys are counted and handled by documented rules.
Logic & conditional aggregation	IFS/boundaries and SUMIFS/COUNTIFS/AVERAGEIFS match business definitions.
Lookup & errors	Master-key suitability is checked; Not Found remains visible; errors are handled without hiding structural problems.
Pivot/report	Important summaries reconcile and visuals answer real questions without unsupported causal claims.
Power Query	Refreshable preparation is evidenced where required; loaded output is not manually patched.
Relationships	One-side uniqueness/cardinality reasoning is defensible even if a specific Excel UI is unavailable.
Validation & communication	At least two independent reconciliations; findings supported; limitation stated; learner can explain the build.

6. Exact next route

If every critical competency passes, Gate A ends and M02 is complete. If a critical competency fails, repair it and complete a changed retry. Gate B is only for an explicitly assigned full retest after failed A. In every repair route, save the current attempt, close this review after diagnosis, complete a changed task without answer material, and append new evidence.